PUSHUP COACH

A linear strength plan that takes you from countertop pushups down to full floor pushups — one surface at a time. Test once a week, alternate hard and easy days, do five sets a day, and log every set by hand on page 2.

THE WEEK

DAY 1	DAY 2	DAY 3	DAY 4	DAY 5	DAY 6	DAY 7
Test + Hard	**Easy**	**Hard**	**Easy**	**Hard**	**Easy**	**Rest**

Day 1 is whatever day you start; your rest day is simply the day before your next Day 1.

- **Test + Hard (Day 1)** — the one day you test. Set 1 is as many pushups as you can on your current surface; that number counts as your first set *and* your **max for the week**. Then finish the remaining four hard sets.
- **Hard days** — about **75–80%** of your max per set, **5 sets**, pushed hard with good form. Surface-transition work happens on these days.
- **Easy days** — about **45–50%** of your max, **5 clean sets**, stopping with reps to spare, to sharpen form and recover.
- **Rest** — roughly **4 minutes** between all sets, and a full rest day to recover.

REP TARGETS FROM YOUR WEEKLY MAX

TESTED MAX	HARD / SET	EASY / SET
5	4	2–3
10	8	5
15	11–12	7
20	15–16	9–10
25	19–20	11–13
30	23–24	14–15

How to read it: find your weekly max in the left column. Do the Hard-day number on hard days and the Easy-day number on easy days. Between the rows, just scale to about 75–80% (hard) and 45–50% (easy) of your own max.

THE SURFACE LADDER EASIER → HARDER

Countertop → Chair / Bench → Stairs → Floor

Start on the easiest surface (highest hands) and work down to the hardest (floor). The higher your hands, the easier the pushup.

MOVING TO THE NEXT SURFACE

1. When your weekly max reaches **20** on your current surface, begin the next, harder one.
2. On hard days, do **Set 1 on the new surface** for max clean reps (aim 15+); keep the other four sets on your old surface at the hard target.
3. Each time you hit **15+ reps** on the new surface, move one more set down to it the next hard day.
4. When **all 5 sets** are on the new surface, it becomes your base — rebuild your reps until you reach 20 again, then repeat.

INCORPORATING FLOOR PUSHUPS FROM STAIRS

1. **Phase 1:** 1 floor pushup as the very first rep of the workout; all sets on stairs.
2. **Phase 2:** 1 floor pushup to open every set; finish each set on stairs.
3. **Phase 3:** 2–3 floor pushups before Set 1; finish Set 1 and all sets on stairs.
4. **Phase 4:** entire Set 1 on the floor; Sets 2–5 on stairs.
5. **Then:** move Set 2, then 3, 4, then 5 to the floor one at a time until all five sets are full floor pushups.

WORKOUT LOG

Write the date and day type (Test / Hard / Easy / Rest), the surface, and the reps for each set. On transition days, note which sets were on the harder surface.

DATE	DAY TYPE	SURFACE(S)	SET 1	SET 2	SET 3	SET 4	SET 5	NOTES